

# Building a Hair Care Routine

*Prescribing for a real person — across texture, climate, season, and budget*

## Learning Objectives

- Recommend a wash-day frequency appropriate to a client's texture and scalp condition
- Build a five-step routine using the fewest products that achieve the goal
- Adjust a routine for India's seasonal extremes — monsoon humidity and dry winter climates
- Prescribe within a client's stated budget without compromising on the essentials

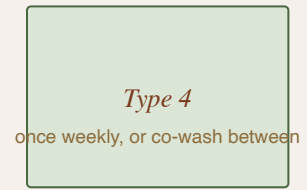
A routine is a prescription, not a shopping list

Every client this course has taught you to assess in Modules Two, Three, and Eight arrives, eventually, at the same question: "So what should I actually be doing?" The answer is never a generic five-step regimen copied from a magazine. It is a small number of deliberate choices, matched precisely to the texture, porosity, density, scalp condition, climate, and budget sitting in front of you.

Wash-day frequency, by texture

Return to Module One's sebum production and Module Two's porosity. Straighter, finer hair sits closer to the scalp, so sebum travels down the strand quickly, often requiring washing every one to two days. Coilier, drier textures hold their shape further from the scalp, sebum travels more slowly, and over-washing strips moisture the hair badly needs — once or twice a week, sometimes with a gentler co-wash (conditioner-only cleansing) between full shampoos, usually serves these textures far better.

◆ Figure 13.1 · Wash Frequency by Texture



General starting points only — always adjust for individual scalp oiliness, activity level, and climate.

### The five building blocks

1. **Cleanse** — a shampoo matched to scalp condition, not marketing claims (referring back to Module Four's ingredient literacy).
2. **Condition** — every wash, focused from mid-length to ends, rarely needed at the root.
3. **Treat** — a weekly deep conditioner or protein treatment, balanced per Module Four's protein-moisture principle.
4. **Style** — the minimum product needed to achieve the desired look, applied to damp hair for most textures.
5. **Protect** — a heat protectant before any thermal styling, and a satin or silk wrap overnight, per Module Six.

A complete routine can be built from five products. It rarely needs to be built from fifteen.

### India's seasonal extremes

- **Monsoon humidity.** Excess moisture in the air causes the cuticle to swell and lift, producing frizz regardless of texture. Anti-humidity serums and lightweight, non-greasy sealants help; heavy oils applied right before stepping outside often worsen limpness in humid air, though they remain excellent as an overnight pre-wash treatment.
- **Dry winter climates.** Low humidity in northern regions strips moisture rapidly, especially from Type 3-4 textures. Richer leave-in conditioners, more frequent oiling per Module Five, and reduced wash frequency all help preserve moisture through the season.
- **Coastal humidity and salt exposure.** Frequent clarifying (but not stripping) washes prevent salt and mineral buildup, paired with strong moisture replenishment afterward.

## Prescribing within a budget

A client's stated budget is not a constraint to work around apologetically — it is information to prescribe against precisely. If forced to choose, prioritise a well-matched shampoo and conditioner first (used most frequently, so quality here compounds), a single weekly treatment second, and treat styling products as the most postponable category. A well-chosen five-product routine within a modest budget will always outperform a mismatched fifteen-product routine bought on impulse.

### Key Terms

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1

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2

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### Practical Activity · The Full Prescription

Using the texture map from Module Two and the assessment card from Module Three, build a complete five-block routine for that same client or model, including wash frequency and one seasonal adjustment. **File this alongside your earlier records — it completes your consultation trilogy for the capstone.**